



at the Nehru Stadium, matching the tally at the 2024 World Championships in Kobe. However, India exceeded Kobe's total medal count: the 73-member contingent won 22 medals — six gold, nine silver, and seven bronze — finishing 10th in the medal standings.

This was an improvement from the previous edition in 2024, when India won 17 medals (six gold, five silver, and six bronze). By comparison, India had secured nine

medals in Dubai in 2019 and ten in Paris in 2023, indicating a clear upward trend. But maintaining the same number of gold medals as in Kobe is particularly impressive, given the stronger field in a non-Paralympic year.

But there was more to the Indian performance than just the medals won.

As Simran and her guide stormed to the finish line in the women's 100m, they clocked 11.95 seconds —

Redemption, at last: Shailesh Kumar won gold in men's high jump T63 event. For India, it was the first of its six gold medals while for Shailesh, it provided redemption after a heart-breaking fourth-place finish at Paris Paralympics.

SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

a personal best and the first time she had ever run under 12 seconds. "All my life I've been chasing this time. I was finally able to get it at my home World Championships," said Simran, who also set an Asian record of 24.46s en route to a silver medal in the women's 200m T12.

Some credit for the quick time should go to the advanced Mondo track surface installed at the JLN Stadium at a cost of around ₹25 crore, which included the warm-up track. However, the track alone cannot explain India's exceptional

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